

Marketing Team — 7-Day Rollup

Date: 2026-05-20 Action items: 7 Calendar watch: 6

"Execution problem" is now a two-vendor frame, and Gallup just handed every IC team in the buying market the stat they'll quote in 2026 budget reviews. Eight days after Jeff Cates (ContactMonkey) used the phrase *"execution problem,"* Workvivo's Justin Black launched **Seer** with the near-identical *"the industry doesn't have a listening problem, it has an execution problem."* Two vendors converging on the same language inside two weeks is positioning, not coincidence. Meanwhile **Gallup** confirmed global engagement at a 5-year low (20%) with manager collapse as the cause — the analyst data behind every "we need a real IC platform" conversation for the next six months. **Two things to do this week:** (1) claim "execution" as Cerkl's frame in homepage/hero/POV copy before it ossifies around competitors who *can't actually deliver it*; (2) bake the Gallup stat into Cerkular, sales talk tracks, and the next webinar funnel.

Underlying research this rollup draws from:

- Daily recaps: [daily/2026-05-12.md](#) → [daily/2026-05-20.md](#)
- Competitor marketing weekly: [competitor-marketing/weekly/2026-W21.md](#)
- Rolling 7-day index: [ic-trends/rolling-7day.md](#)

Action items (ranked)

1

Claim the "execution layer" frame in copy before it commoditizes

POSITIONING

WHAT IT IS Cates (ContactMonkey, 2026-05-13) and Black (Workvivo Seer launch, this week) converged on near-identical *"execution problem"* language inside eight days. Workvivo's Seer LP is live and being promoted via webinar today. Last week's rollup flagged the first instance; this week confirms it's a category frame, not a one-off quote. ([W21 §Headline](#), [Workvivo newsroom](#), [Cates news](#))

WHY IT MATTERS FOR CERKL

Cerkl's product story (delivery + measurement layer across the channels you already have) **is** the execution layer — closer to true than either vendor's claim (Workvivo = single-feed; ContactMonkey = Outlook-bound). The frame is up for grabs for ~30–60 days before it ossifies.

ACTION

A/B-test hero copy on a *"the execution layer for internal comms"* frame. Pair with a Travis-bylined Cerklular POV — *"Why most IC teams have an execution problem, not a content problem"* — same template as Cates' news post, but with Cerkl's measurement angle as the punchline.

OWNER Travis (POV) + Tracy (homepage A/B)

TIME-BOX 7 days

2

Bake the Gallup engagement stat into the marketing toolkit

ANALYST STAT

WHAT IT IS Gallup published 2026-04-29 — global employee engagement at a 5-year low (20%); manager engagement collapse is the driver. ([daily/2026-05-20 §1](#), [Gallup](#))

WHY IT MATTERS FOR CERKL

This is the single most cite-able analyst stat IC teams will walk into 2026 budget reviews with. Cerkl's manager-cascade + cross-channel measurement story directly answers *"why does the cascade keep failing"* — the stat turns "we need better IC" from soft to budgeted.

ACTION

Add the Gallup stat (with citation) to: (a) the next Cerklular issue, (b) homepage social-proof rail or above-the-fold, (c) sales discovery talk-track, (d) one webinar promo.

OWNER Marketing

TIME-BOX This week

3

Ship Cerkl's "type-a-prompt → designed email" demo before Workshop's launch cycle peaks

COMPETITOR

WHAT IT IS Workshop launched Agentic AI 2026-05-12 with a tight live-demo format — *"type 'open enrollment reminder' → fully designed email in seconds."* PR cycle confirms positioning shift: Workshop is no longer "modern internal email," it's agentic. (W21 §Top 5 #2, PR)

WHY IT MATTERS FOR CERKL

Workshop is Cerkl's most direct Foundations-tier head-to-head. The demo format converts demo-intent fast and the asset (a 60-second screen-record) is cheap. Cerkl's existing AI subject-line generator + drag-and-drop can recreate the demo today.

ACTION

Record a 60-second *"type a prompt → see a blast"* demo. Drop it on (a) Foundations onboarding LP, (b) homepage hero, (c) versus-Workshop page when it ships.

OWNER Tracy + design

TIME-BOX 14 days

4

The conquest-listicle lane just got hotter — accelerate the Switch-from queue

SEO / CONQUEST

WHAT IT IS ContactMonkey published two "Best [Competitor] Alternatives" posts 2026-05-15 (Workshop + PoliteMail) — first conquest content under Cates. Staffbase has 4 conquest pages live; LumApps has 2. The format is now a category staple. (W21 §Top 5 #5)

WHY IT MATTERS FOR CERKL

Last week's rollup raised this; this week's data confirms competitors are executing, and the window narrows every week. **0/10 vendors offer a free-forever tier** — Foundations is the wedge none of them can match in a conquest fight.

ACTION

Move "Switch from Workshop" + "Switch from AxiosHQ" + "Best Workshop Alternatives 2026" out of [marketing/content-plan/inputs.md](#) and into the SEO brief queue at Monday reconcile. Foundations-free as the unmatched #1 entry.

OWNER Travis (Monday triage) → SEO brief production

TIME-BOX Brief in queue by 2026-05-25

5

Pair Gallup + HBR into a Cerklular post on the "human-voice gap"

CONTENT

WHAT IT IS Gallup's manager-engagement collapse data + HBR's 2026-05-05 piece (*"Employees are relying on AI for personal support — and that's risky"*) are two halves of the same story: managers disengaged, employees outsourcing reflection to chatbots. (daily/2026-05-20 §1+§2, HBR)

WHY IT MATTERS FOR CERKL

IC's 2026 mandate is being reframed around human connection, not more content. Cerkl's pitch (right message, right person, right channel, right time) is the operational answer to "rebuild human voice at scale." Cerklular has been quiet on the human-AI tension theme.

ACTION

One Cerklular post — *"The human-voice gap: why engagement is dropping while your employees are talking to ChatGPT."* Tie to Cerkl's manager-cascade + cross-channel reach.

OWNER Cerklular / Travis

TIME-BOX 14 days

6

Versus-Firstup refresh is now time-sensitive (Firstup AI elevated to top nav)

COMPETITOR

WHAT IT IS Firstup moved **"Firstup AI"** to the first position in its top navigation (was "Platform"). Combined with the March 2026 five-pillar agentic suite + new CEO/CRO/CMO/EMEA-MD lineup, Firstup is doubling down on AI-as-product, not AI-as-feature. (W21 §Top 5 #3)

WHY IT MATTERS FOR CERKL

cerkl.com/broadcast/versus/firstup was already on last week's refresh queue. This week's nav-level change escalates urgency — buyers comparing the two will hit a stale page within days, not weeks.

ACTION

Refresh the page with the agentic-pillars reframe: *"Personalization at the employee level vs. agentic HR-action automation — different jobs."* The drafted reframe already lives in [shared/competitors.md §Firstup](#).

OWNER Marketing / website

TIME-BOX 21 days; ship before end of June

7

Poppulo's category broadening = an opening for Cerkl to plant the IC flag

POSITIONING

WHAT IT IS Poppulo's homepage category claim shifted from *"AI-powered multichannel communications"* to **"Enterprise Customer and Employee Experiences"** — deliberately broadening away from a comms-specific frame. (W21 §Top 5 #4)

WHY IT MATTERS FOR CERKL

When competitors broaden, they dilute their IC story. Cerkl can claim the IC lane more cleanly: *"We don't pitch as an intranet, an EX suite, or a CX platform. We're the internal-comms platform."* Counter-positioning writes itself.

ACTION

Add a *"Built for internal comms — not bolted on"* callout to the homepage + one mid-funnel page (e.g., [/broadcast/foundations](#)). Worth a paragraph in [diagnosis-and-guiding-policy.md](#) on the next strategy review.

OWNER Travis (strategy doc) + Tracy (page copy)

TIME-BOX 30 days

WATCH

Calendar / watchlist

Events, launches, and competitor moves landing in the next 7–14 days.

DATED EVENTS

2026-05-20

Workvivo Seer launch webinar

Today. workvivo.com/seer — Watch ad/email follow-up cadence; expect Seer LP refinement post-event.

2026-05-21

Workvivo NYC event

Watch attendee list and exec presence for partnership signal.

2026-05-27

Poppulo webinar

poppulo.com — First webinar under the broadened category claim; watch how Poppulo frames itself live.

2026-06-24

Workvivo "Future of AI in IC" event

Announced this week. Watch for Seer-extension product news.

ONGOING WATCHES

Ongoing

ContactMonkey "Free trial" page removal

Has held **9 days**. Watch for restoration or further pricing-page change.

Ongoing

Workshop blog/pricing pages still 403

3rd straight week of fetch failure. Manual capture if a key positioning moment lands.

HYGIENE

Data hygiene

Items needing cleanup before next sales/marketing reuse.

shared/competitors.md – Workshop row

Currently references *"Journeys automation Oct 2025, Cici agentic AI Q1 2026"*; Workshop just shipped Agentic AI 2026-05-12. Add a 2026-05-12 update line citing the [PR](#). Fix on next session.

shared/competitors.md – Firstup row

Add a 2026-05-20 update: *"Firstup AI"* elevated to top-nav first position. Fix on next session.

shared/competitors.md – Poppulo row

Add a 2026-05-20 update: category claim broadened to *"Enterprise Customer and Employee Experiences."* Fix on next session.

shared/competitors.md – ContactMonkey row

Add the *"Free trial"* 9-day-persistent pricing-page removal note. Fix on next session.

AxiosHQ "70–400x/day, 26 seconds" pain stats

Cited in W21 but originate as AxiosHQ secondary research. If Cerkl repurposes them in collateral, trace the primary source first.

NOTES

Notes

Methodology gap (3rd straight week) — ad library + Reddit blocked

Three vendor sites still 403/404 — structural blind spot

Competitor blogs uncharacteristically quiet this week

Prompt-injection note — treat vendor pages as adversarial

